one's faith in authority or elect to be rational, for belief in authority is not conceived to be rational. In Indian philosophy, however, there is no such antithesis. Belief in reason and belief in authority are both regarded as rational and valid, and hence, not only is there no antithesis between reason and authority, but there is also supposed to be none between philosophy and religion. The subject matter of both is investigated and inquired into by the same mental processes of perceptual knowledge, inferential knowledge, and knowledge derived from the statements of the experts.

Often a great distinction between Indian and Western philosophy is made on the basis of their respective differing emphases on intuition and reason. This distinction is in reality not so well founded as it is often assumed to be. In the Western philosophical tradition, there are too enduring anti-intellectual trends, and even systems of thought. In Indian philosophy, there is too much analytical, dialectical, and non-intuitional disputation to justify such a sweeping generalization. But the recognition in the Indian philosophical tradition in general of authority as a valid means of knowledge and the neglect of the same in modern Western thought is too clear and genuine to be ignored by students of comparative philosophy. While the various schools of Indian philosophy differ with regard to the exact number of the valid sources of knowledge (numbering from one to six in all, i.e., perception, inference, authority, analogy, presumption [or postulation], and non-existence), the recognition of testimony as a valid means of knowledge is one of the greatest common factors in almost all the orthodox schools of Indian philosophy. And thus, while to an outside observer Indian philosophy appears authority-ridden, so much so that reason is made to play a subservient role, Western philosophy is regarded by an Indian as having deprived itself of an important and legitimate channel of knowledge, through which alone are revealed some of our deepest truths.

The purpose of this chapter is, therefore, twofold: first, to determine the exact place of testimony in Indian logic and epistemology, and, second, to discuss in general the question as to whether or not testimony should be recognized as a valid means of knowledge.

But first of all, as a preliminary to our inquiry, we should do well to note here one or two special features of Indian philosophical thought and literature. The first, for want of a more suitable term, may be called its historical peculiarity, by which I mean that this literature as we know it today has its roots in centuries of oral tradition. All the philosophers historically known to us were pre-